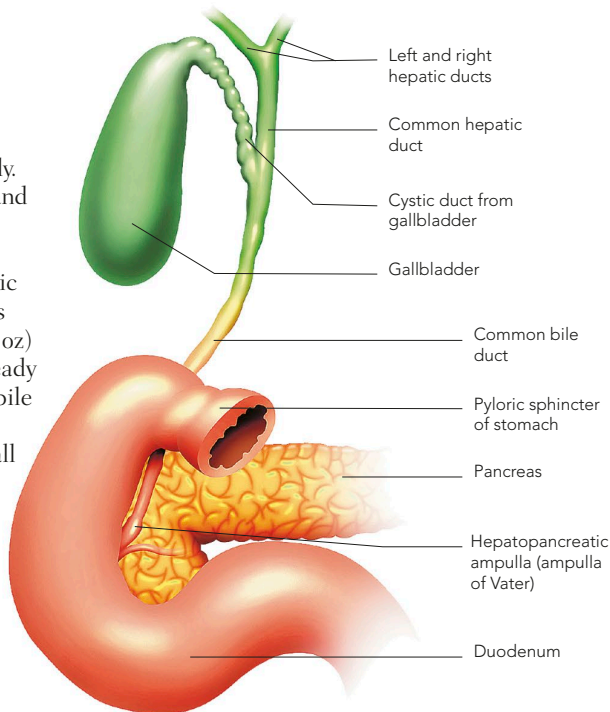


## BILE TRANSPORT

Bile assists the breakdown of fats (lipids) in the small intestine. The liver secretes up to 1 litre ( $1\frac{2}{3}$  pints) of bile daily. The bile passes along the left and right hepatic ducts from the liver's two lobes, then along the common hepatic and cystic ducts to the gallbladder. This sac holds around 50ml ( $1\frac{2}{3}$  fl oz) of bile and concentrates it, ready for release after a meal. The bile flows along the cystic duct to enter the first part of the small intestine, the duodenum.



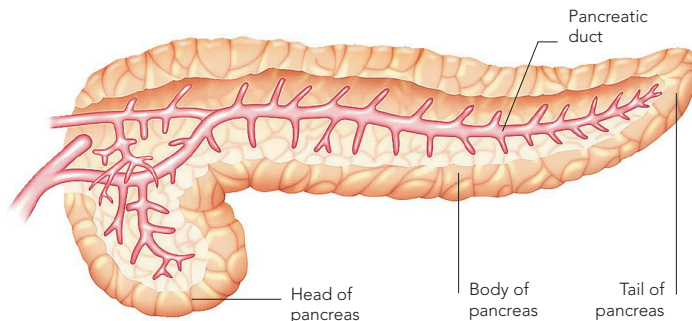
## DUAL DUCTS

The common bile duct joins the pancreatic duct at the hepatopancreatic ampulla, which empties into the duodenum.

## THE PANCREAS

The head end of this gland nestles in a loop of the duodenum, its main body lies behind the stomach, and its tapering tail sits above the left kidney, below the spleen. Each day, the pancreas produces around 1.5 litres ( $2\frac{2}{3}$  pints)

of digestive juice containing various enzymes that break down proteins, carbohydrates, and lipids. The fluid flows into the main and accessory pancreatic ducts, which empty the juices into the duodenum.



## PANCREATIC STRUCTURE

The pancreas is up to 15cm (6in) long, soft and flexible, and grey-pink in colour.